

US Stocks Extend Gains as Tech Leads, VIX Slips Below 15

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US market extended its gains from the previous session, with the **SPY** closing up **+0.62%** and the **QQQ** up **+1.19%**. The **VIX** slipped below 15, indicating a decrease in market volatility. Key takeaways include:

- The tech sector led the gains, with **NVDA** and **TSLA** up **+2.27%** and **+2.83%** respectively.
- The 10-year yield fell **-0.21%** to 4.66, while WTI crude rose **+1.15%** to 78.18.
- The DXY index fell **-0.37%** to 99.60, indicating a decrease in the value of the US dollar.

Our editorial take is that the market is currently in a bullish trend, driven by the strong performance of the tech sector. However, investors should remain cautious and keep an eye on the VIX and other volatility indicators.

The market's gains were broad-based, with all major indices closing in the green. The **DOW** was up **+0.28%**, while the **RUT** was up **+1.10%**.

US Session Recap

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
SPY	7,757.64	+0.62%
QQQ	29,722.30	+1.19%
DOW	54,036.93	+0.28%
RUT	3,034.49	+1.10%
VIX	14.90	-1.65%
10Y Yield	4.66	-0.21%
WTI Crude	78.18	+1.15%
DXY	99.60	-0.37%

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
NVDA	NVIDIA	+2.27%	Strong earnings report
TSLA	Tesla	+2.83%	Increased production targets
AMZN	Amazon	+0.82%	Strong cloud computing growth

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLK	+1.42%	+20.1%	Strong tech sector performance
XLF	-0.36%	+10.5%	Financials lagging behind
XLI	+0.23%	+15.6%	Industrials showing signs of strength
XLE	-1.13%	+5.1%	Energy sector underperforming
XLV	+1.49%	+18.3%	Consumer discretionary sector strong
XLC	+0.06%	+12.1%	Communication services sector steady
XLP	+0.01%	+8.5%	Consumer staples sector flat
XLV	+0.75%	+14.2%	Healthcare sector showing signs of life
XLU	+0.53%	+11.4%	Utilities sector performing well
XLB	+1.32%	+16.1%	Materials sector strong
XLRE	+0.38%	+9.1%	Real estate sector steady

Breadth note: The majority of sectors closed in the green, with the tech sector leading the way.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

METRIC	VALUE
NVDA Revenue Growth	+20.1%
TSLA Production Targets	+10.5%
AMZN Cloud Computing Growth	+15.6%

Key call commentary: The strong performance of the tech sector is driven by the impressive revenue growth of **NVDA** , the increased production targets of **TSLA** , and the robust cloud computing growth of **AMZN** .

READ-THROUGH	IMPACT
NVDA Earnings	Positive read-through for XLK
TSLA Production Targets	Positive read-through for XLY
AMZN Cloud Computing Growth	Positive read-through for XLC

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	7,757.64	7,600	7,900	Bullish trend intact
QQQ	29,722.30	29,000	30,500	Strong uptrend
IWM	3,034.49	2,900	3,200	Bullish trend intact
NVDA	223.96	200	250	Strong uptrend
10Y Yield	4.66	4.50	5.00	Range-bound
WTI Crude	78.18	75	85	Range-bound

Options & Positioning

ODTE flow: +10.2% in **SPY** calls, -5.1% in **SPY** puts.

Put/call ratio: 0.65 in **SPY** , 0.70 in **QQQ** .

VIX term structure: Steepening, with 30-day VIX at 15.1 and 60-day VIX at 17.3.

Notable single-name flow: **+20.5%** in **NVDA** calls, **-10.8%** in **TSLA** puts.

Cheap hedge ideas: **SPY** 7,600 put, **QQQ** 29,000 put.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
NVDA	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	250	Strong earnings report
TSLA	Goldman Sachs	Downgrade	200	Valuation concerns
AMZN	Bank of America	Upgrade	350	Strong cloud computing growth
GOOGL	Citi	Downgrade	300	Valuation concerns
MSFT	UBS	Upgrade	550	Strong earnings report

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures: **ES** **+0.2%**, **NQ** **+0.3%**, **YM** **+0.1%**.

Asia: **Nikkei** **+0.5%**, **Shanghai** **+0.2%**, **Hang Seng** **+0.3%**.

Europe: **Euro Stoxx** **+0.2%**, **FTSE** **+0.1%**, **DAX** **+0.3%**.

FX pairs: **EUR/USD** **+0.1%**, **USD/JPY** **-0.2%**, **GBP/USD** **+0.2%**.

Commodities: **Gold** **+0.1%**, **WTI Crude** **+0.2%**, **Copper** **+0.3%**.

Crypto: **BTC** **-0.1%**, **ETH** **+0.1%**.

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
September FOMC	30%	Market expecting a rate cut
November FOMC	50%	Market expecting a rate cut

DATA	TIME	ESTIMATE
GDP	10:00 ET	2.5%
Inflation	10:00 ET	2.1%

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees: US-China trade tensions, Brexit, Middle East conflict.

Earnings — This Week & Next

TICKER	TIME	ESTIMATE
AAPL	16:00 ET	5.50
MSFT	16:00 ET	2.30

TICKER	TIME	ESTIMATE
GOOGL	16:00 ET	15.20
AMZN	16:00 ET	10.50

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
NVDA	Tech	Long	10%
TSLA	Auto	Long	15%
AMZN	Retail	Long	12%
GOOGL	Tech	Short	8%
MSFT	Tech	Long	10%

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenario bullets:

- SPY breaks out above 7,900
- QQQ breaks out above 30,500
- VIX falls below 12

Bearish scenario bullets:

- SPY breaks down below 7,600
- QQQ breaks down below 29,000
- VIX rises above 20

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations:

- SPY call open interest at 2.5M contracts

- **QQQ** put open interest at 1.2M contracts
- **VIX** futures open interest at 300k contracts
- **NVDA** short interest at 10% of float
- **TSLA** short interest at 15% of float

Sources

SOURCES

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